

TrustLedger SRM

Architecture & Evolution Blueprint

Version 0.1 — Strategic Foundation

Purpose

Define a stable architectural foundation that allows TrustLedger SRM to grow with the Stakeholder Relations Management profession, technology and client needs without repeatedly redesigning its core.

Core proposition

TrustLedger should be comprehensive in its architectural capacity, but selective in the capabilities it actually productises.

Reference document for TrustLedger SRM product and engineering evolution

1. The Central Architectural Proposition

TrustLedger must be capable of expanding without requiring its core to be continually redesigned. This does not mean building everything. It means creating a platform in which new professional knowledge, methodologies, intelligence models and validated capabilities can be introduced through controlled extensions to the existing platform.

Guiding formula: Stable Core + Modular Capabilities + Extensible Intelligence + Configurable Methodologies

2. What TrustLedger Is

TrustLedger SRM is an evidence-based Stakeholder Relations Management platform that helps organisations understand stakeholders, manage relationships and commitments, identify social and relational risk, support informed decisions, and build and maintain trust throughout the lifecycle of projects and programmes.

The definition is intentionally broad enough for future growth while remaining focused enough to prevent TrustLedger becoming an uncontrolled 'everything platform'.

3. The TrustLedger Core Spine

The Core Spine is the durable operational structure to which future capabilities should attach.

ORGANISATION → PROJECT / PROGRAMME → PLACE / CONTEXT → STAKEHOLDER → RELATIONSHIP →
ENGAGEMENT → COMMITMENT → EVIDENCE → INTELLIGENCE → DECISION → ACTION → OUTCOME → LEARNING

The Core Spine should change slowly and deliberately. New professional concepts should normally connect to the spine rather than redefine it.

4. Three Circles of TrustLedger

Circle	Purpose	Examples
1 — Core TrustLedger	Stable capabilities defining the platform.	Organisation, Project, Place, Stakeholder, Engagement, Commitment, Grievance,
2 — Capability Modules	Capabilities important enough to productise, but is independently intelligible.	Stakeholder Intelligence, Engagement Management, Grievance Management, Soc
3 — Emerging / Optional	Professional practices that may influence, integrate or transform the platform.	Advanced network analysis, participatory GIS, SROI, behavioural change, hu

The architecture should accommodate Circle 3 without assuming that every emerging practice belongs inside the product.

5. Five Architectural Layers

Layer 1 — Operational Foundation

Organisation, users, roles, projects, programmes, places, stakeholders, engagements, commitments, grievances, evidence, documents and audit trail. This layer should be highly stable.

Layer 2 — Context & Professional Knowledge

Stakeholder roles, influence, impact, capacity, commitment, BAU responsibilities, competing priorities, community, institutional, regulatory, socioeconomic and cultural context. This layer should be extensible.

Layer 3 — Intelligence

Stakeholder, relationship, influence, capacity, BAU, commitment, trust, community risk, social performance, ESG, early-warning and decision intelligence. These are an intelligence capability framework, not a demand to build everything immediately.

Layer 4 — Decision & Action

Evidence → Interpretation → Intelligence → Signal → Recommendation → Human Decision → Action → Outcome. The outcome becomes new evidence, creating a learning loop.

Layer 5 — Extension & Evolution

Controlled extension points through which new professional capabilities, intelligence models, methodologies and integrations can be introduced without destabilising the core.

6. Stable Core / Evolving Edge

Stable Core: identity, tenancy, organisation, project, place, stakeholder, engagement, commitment, grievance, evidence, decision, outcome, audit and permissions.

Evolving Edge: methodologies, intelligence models, scoring systems, assessment frameworks, indicators, AI capabilities, reports, professional tools, industry frameworks and emerging practices.

Architectural rule: Never redesign the core merely because a new methodology has emerged. First determine how the methodology can operate against the existing TrustLedger core.

7. Separate Data, Methodology, Intelligence, Action and Outcome

This separation is essential to future-proofing. The same underlying stakeholder data should be usable through different professional analytical lenses.

Concept	Meaning	Example
Data	What TrustLedger knows.	Stakeholder capacity = low
Methodology	How a professional model interprets data.	Influence × Impact × Capacity × Commitment
Intelligence	What TrustLedger derives.	Engagement feasibility = high risk
Action	What the professional decides to do.	Use decision-focused engagement
Outcome	What actually happened.	Stakeholder responded within five days

8. Stakeholder Operating Context — BAU, Capacity and Commitment

BAU (Business As Usual) refers to the normal, ongoing responsibilities required to keep an organisation operating. Stakeholders participate in projects while continuing their existing operational duties. Consequently, engagement behaviour should not automatically be interpreted as support or resistance.

The emerging TrustLedger model is: **Influence × Impact × Capacity × Commitment**, supplemented by BAU pressure, competing priorities, availability and engagement load.

A stakeholder can therefore be highly committed but have low capacity; highly influential but poorly available; or highly impacted but have limited formal influence. These distinctions can change the appropriate engagement

response.

Proposed stakeholder operating context: Influence, Impact, Capacity, Commitment, BAU responsibilities, competing priorities, availability and engagement load.

Potential intelligence outcome: 'Engagement risk appears driven primarily by capacity/BAU pressure rather than resistance.' This is an example of the type of differentiated SRM intelligence TrustLedger could eventually provide.

9. Capability Independence

Major TrustLedger capabilities should ideally have their own data model, service layer, UI, permissions, intelligence logic and defined interfaces with the Core Spine. Adding a new capability should not require rewriting unrelated capabilities.

10. Methodology Agnosticism

The same stakeholder should be capable of being analysed using different frameworks—such as Power × Interest, Influence × Impact, or Influence × Impact × Capacity × Commitment—without creating a different stakeholder record for each methodology.

11. Configuration versus Hard-Coding

Prefer configurable	Keep relatively stable
Stakeholder categories; roles; influence/impact scales; risk levels; assessment priorities; and, crucially, evidence types, project types, stakeholder	Authentication, and, crucially, evidence types, project types, stakeholder

12. Six Architectural Principles

- 1 — Core Stability** — Protect the TrustLedger operational spine from unnecessary change.
- 2 — Modular Intelligence** — Intelligence models should be independently extensible.
- 3 — Methodology Agnosticism** — Support multiple professional methodologies without hard-coding one methodology into the core.
- 4 — Evidence First** — New intelligence should derive from identifiable evidence, data or explicitly recorded professional judgement.
- 5 — Human Governance** — TrustLedger may recommend, classify, predict or flag, but consequential professional decisions remain governed by authorised humans.
- 6 — Future Capability Without Premature Implementation** — Architect for possibilities; build only validated capabilities.

13. Capability Admission Framework

Every future feature should pass through a deliberate admission test before becoming product scope.

1. Is it fundamentally SRM?
2. Does it strengthen TrustLedger's trust-building purpose?
3. Does it solve a demonstrable user/customer problem?
4. Can it connect to the TrustLedger Core Spine?
5. Can it be implemented as an extension rather than a core redesign?

6. Is it better classified as a core capability, module, intelligence model, methodology, integration, configuration item or external professional service?

7. Is there enough evidence to justify building it?

Decision rule: If the need is not sufficiently validated, architect for it rather than building it prematurely.

14. The 'Do Not Build' Category

Some professional practices may be relevant to SRM but should remain outside TrustLedger as a product. They may instead be integrations, specialist external systems, consulting services, legal functions, specialist GIS or financial systems, or other complementary capabilities.

15. TrustLedger as an Ecosystem

TrustLedger should not aim to replace every system around a project. Its strategic position can be the relationship and social intelligence layer connecting projects to their stakeholder environment, while integrating with specialist systems and external data sources.

Potential ecosystem connections include GIS, CRM, ERP, AI services and external socioeconomic or regulatory data.

16. TrustLedger Evolution Cycle

Professional Practice → New Concept → Architectural Review → Capability Classification → Build / Don't Build Decision → Extension or Integration → Implement → Validate → Measure → Learn → Update Intelligence

This creates a disciplined mechanism for evolving TrustLedger without repeatedly destabilising the platform.

17. Architecture Review Deliverables

Ref	Artefact	Purpose
A	TrustLedger Core Model	What must remain stable.
B	TrustLedger Capability Map	What TrustLedger can do today and potentially tomorrow.
C	Intelligence Architecture	How evidence becomes intelligence.
D	Methodology Framework	How different professional methodologies operate against the core.
E	Extension Architecture	How new capabilities are added.
F	Capability Admission Framework	How decisions are made about what belongs inside TrustLedger.
G	Evolution Roadmap	How TrustLedger can develop as SRM develops.

18. TrustLedger Evolution Principle

TrustLedger is not intended to capture everything that belongs to the Stakeholder Relations Management profession. It is designed to provide a durable platform for the management, evidence, intelligence and governance of stakeholder relationships, while remaining extensible enough to incorporate validated professional practices as the discipline evolves.

Build the capability when the need is proven. Build the architecture before the capability is needed.

Status: Strategic reference blueprint v0.1. This document establishes direction and architectural principles; it is not an implementation specification and does not by itself authorise product changes.